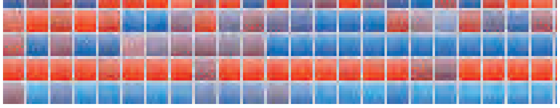

IPv6?
With less than 10 per cent IPv4 addresses left, we need to move to IPv6

Book Studio was connected via the FireWire interface, it gave a better performance than the WD Elite. This can be attributed to the fact that FireWire has comparatively larger data transfer speeds as compared to USB 2.0 interface.

The Buffalo Drive Station on the other hand was in an altogether different league with the USB 3.0 interface. As boasted on the cover of the hard drive, the USB 3.0 interface indeed gave us three times faster performance as compared to the USB 2.0 interface. Where the read burst speed for the FireWire interface of WD Studio tallied to 41.6 MBps, that of Buffalo zoomed to 126.2 MBps, a three-fold jump in the readings. Same was true for write speeds as well.

True performance is however tested in real life tests like data transfer speeds. Between the WD Studio and WD Elite, for a USB 2.0 interface, Elite gave a better performance. It took less time to read / write and open the 1 GB Photoshop file. But using the firewire port on WD Studio dwarfs the WD Elite scores. There is a 15-20 per cent improvement in performance when a FireWire port is used on the WD Studio as compared to the USB 2.0 ports.

The Buffalo drive was a winner in the synthetic tests, so it was expected to be a winner in the real life tests as well. If the numbers are anything to go by, then USB 3.0 is going to be the next thing to watch out for. As the capacity of the drives increases it only makes sense to increase the data transfer speeds. USB 3.0 interface is a start in that direction.

A sequential 4GB file took 41 secs and 45 secs for a read and write operation respectively. This is nearly a 60 per cent improvement from the fastest firewire port of WD Studio. As far as transfer speeds go, there was simply no competition to Buffalo Drive Station. But when we interfaced the Drive station with a USB 2.0 port we got results similiar to the rest of the drives. So to get a performance, users need to use the USB 3.0 interface which can be brought separately. The one that we used costs around Rs. 4,500 which is quite an investment.

Seagate FreeAgent Desk 1TB

Conclusion

In the desktop hard drives, we found that the Buffalo DriveStation zoomed with its high data transfer speeds. But as it was the only USB 3.0 compatible drive, we haven't used it as a reference point for portable hard drive testing. We felt that for users who are willing to spend and who expect quick data transfer, Buffalo DriveStation is the ideal drive to go for. Although for Rs 18,000, we feel its steeply priced but its performance is unmatched. Regular home users wanting a better cost per GB, should go for our Best Buy – Seagate Desk Agent priced at Rs. 7,500.

Among the portable hard drives, Transcend StoreJet 25M was the fastest drive. A-DATA Nobility gave 90 per cent of the performance of Transcend at a very minimal price of Rs 2,900, so we felt it deserved the Best Buy.

If you're looking at buying external hard drive, low cost per GB is one necessity, but that should not be the *only* aspect as data transfer speeds also need to be considered. Happy shopping!